Conversation track 22, 24, 25

Marco and Nhi are having their first meeting about a new customer survey project.

Marco: OK, let's **kick off**. We need to **come up with** a plan for the customer survey.

Nhi: Sure. I can **set up** a meeting with marketing first thing tomorrow.

Marco: Brilliant. Who's going to **carry out** the actual interviews?

Nhi: I'll **take** that **on**. But we can't **put off** the budget question any longer.

Marco: Fair point. I'll **follow up** with finance this afternoon.

Nhi: Great. And if we **fall behind**, let's flag it early.

Marco: Agreed. Shall we **catch up** again on Friday?

Nhi: Perfect. I'll **send out** a quick summary after this meeting.

Study Notes

I can set up a meeting with marketing first thing tomorrow.
Tôi có thể hẹn họp với bên marketing ngay đầu giờ sáng mai.
"first thing tomorrow" là ngay đầu giờ sáng mai, trước mọi việc khác.
Cách nói tương đương: I'll set up a meeting early tomorrow.

If we fall behind, let's flag it early.
Nếu bị chậm tiến độ thì mình báo sớm nhé.
"flag something" là nêu ra, cảnh báo một vấn đề để mọi người chú ý.
Cách nói tương đương: If we're running late, let's say so early.

Speak Like a Native track 23

1. I'll take that on.
weak: "I'll"
linking: "that‿on"
strong: "on"
Tiểu từ "on" đứng cuối câu được nhấn. "that on" nối thành "đé-đan" (giọng Mỹ, t → d nhẹ). "I'll" đọc nhẹ, gần như "al".

2. But we can't put off the budget question any longer.
change: "put‿off" (t → d nhẹ)
strong: "can't", "budget", "longer"
Giọng Mỹ đọc "can't" /kænt/ "ken", âm /t/ cuối gần như mất; giọng Anh đọc /kɑːnt/ "caant". "put off" nối thành "pu-đof".

3. Fair point. I'll follow up with finance this afternoon.
linking: "follow‿up‿with"
strong: "finance", "afternoon"
"follow up" nối thành "fo-lâu-wớp" (chèn âm /w/ nhẹ). Giọng Anh đọc "afternoon" /ˌɑːftəˈnuːn/ "aaf-tơ-nuun"; giọng Mỹ /ˌæftərˈnuːn/ "ép-tơr-nuun".

- Cụm động từ đọc liền: kick off → "ki-kof", take that on → "tây-đé-đan".
- Tiểu từ (on, off, up) đứng cuối câu thường được nhấn: I'll take that ON.
- "can't" luôn được nhấn để không nhầm với "can" (đọc nhẹ /kən/).
- can't, afternoon: giọng Anh (Marco) đọc với /ɑː/, giọng Mỹ (Nhi) đọc với /æ/.

Grammar Focus

Cụm động từ khi bắt đầu dự án: kick off / set up / come up with

kick off = bắt đầu (cuộc họp, dự án); set up = sắp xếp, thiết lập; come up with = nghĩ ra (ý tưởng, kế hoạch); take on = nhận làm.

Let's **kick off** with a quick update.
Can you **set up** a call with the client?
We need to **come up with** a better name.

Cụm động từ khi theo dõi tiến độ: follow up / put off / fall behind

follow up (on / with) = liên hệ lại, theo dõi tiếp; put off = hoãn lại; fall behind = bị chậm tiến độ; carry out = thực hiện.

I'll **follow up** with an email tomorrow.
Don't **put off** the hard decisions.
We **fell behind** because of the holidays.

Role Play track 27

A: OK, let's kick off. We need to come up with a plan for the customer survey.

B: Sure. I can _____ first thing tomorrow.

A: Brilliant. Who's going to carry out the actual interviews?

B: I'll take that on. But we can't _____ the budget question any longer.

A: Fair point. I'll follow up with finance this afternoon.

B: Great. And if we fall behind, let's flag it early.

A: Agreed. Shall we catch up again on Friday?

B: Perfect. I'll _____ a quick summary after this meeting.

Substitution Drill track 28

1. I can set up a meeting with marketing first thing tomorrow.
   a. draw up a timeline
   b. line up some customers
   c. set up a shared folder

2. But we can't put off the budget question any longer.
   a. push back
   b. sit on
   c. keep dodging

3. I'll send out a quick summary after this meeting.
   a. write up
   b. put together
   c. circulate